

IBEW Aptitude Test Reading Comprehension

READING COMPREHENSION Exam 6

Part A — Passages and Questions

Time Limit — Full Section: 51 Minutes

Passage 1

A regional warehouse recently introduced a new system for tracking incoming deliveries. In the past, receiving clerks recorded shipments on paper forms and later entered the information into a computer. This process sometimes caused delays because paperwork could be incomplete, misplaced, or entered incorrectly.

The new system allows clerks to scan delivery documents as soon as shipments arrive. Information is automatically uploaded to the warehouse database, where supervisors can review delivery times, quantities, and supplier information. Managers report that records are now available more quickly and that fewer corrections are needed.

The warehouse also uses the data to identify suppliers that frequently deliver late or send incomplete orders. By reviewing this information, managers can address recurring problems and improve planning.

RC6-001

Question: What is the main idea of the passage?

- A) The warehouse stopped accepting incoming deliveries.
 - B) A new tracking system improved delivery recordkeeping.
 - C) Receiving clerks no longer check shipments.
 - D) Suppliers now control the warehouse database.
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RC6-002

Question: What problem occurred with the previous process?

- A) Shipments arrived too early.

- B) Paperwork could be incomplete, misplaced, or entered incorrectly.
 - C) Supervisors refused to review delivery records.
 - D) Suppliers stopped sending delivery documents.
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RC6-003

Question: What happens when clerks scan delivery documents?

- A) Information is automatically uploaded to the warehouse database.
 - B) Shipments are returned to suppliers.
 - C) Paper records are mailed to customers.
 - D) Delivery trucks are assigned new routes.
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RC6-004

Question: What can managers identify by reviewing the data?

- A) Employees who need vacation time
 - B) Suppliers that frequently deliver late or send incomplete orders
 - C) Products that should be advertised
 - D) Customers who visit the warehouse
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RC6-005

Question: The word “recurring” most nearly means:

- A) Repeating
 - B) Hidden
 - C) Expensive
 - D) Temporary
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Passage 2

NOTICE

Beginning January 8, all employees must complete the updated safety orientation before using the new loading dock equipment. The orientation includes a brief classroom review and a supervised equipment demonstration.

The updated orientation was created after supervisors observed that some employees were unfamiliar with the new controls. The goal is to ensure that all workers understand proper operating procedures before working independently.

Employees should schedule their orientation through the training office. Supervisors will verify completion before assigning employees to loading dock duties.

RC6-006

Question: What is the purpose of the notice?

- A) To announce a required safety orientation
 - B) To advertise a new warehouse position
 - C) To explain payroll changes
 - D) To cancel loading dock operations
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RC6-007

Question: What does the orientation include?

- A) A written sales report
 - B) A classroom review and supervised equipment demonstration
 - C) A customer service interview
 - D) A warehouse inventory count
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RC6-008

Question: Why was the updated orientation created?

- A) Some employees were unfamiliar with the new controls.

- B) The loading dock equipment was removed.
 - C) Customers requested faster deliveries.
 - D) Employees wanted longer break periods.
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RC6-009

Question: Who will verify that employees completed the orientation?

- A) Customers
 - B) Suppliers
 - C) Supervisors
 - D) Delivery drivers
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Passage 3

Many businesses use inventory forecasts to estimate future product demand. A forecast may be based on past sales, seasonal patterns, customer orders, and current market conditions. Although forecasts are not always exact, they can help companies make better decisions about purchasing and production.

If a company orders too much inventory, it may spend money storing products that do not sell quickly. If it orders too little, it may run out of popular items and disappoint customers. A useful forecast helps businesses balance these risks.

Managers often review forecasts regularly and adjust them when new information becomes available. This process allows companies to respond more effectively to changing conditions.

RC6-010

Question: What is the main idea of the passage?

- A) Inventory forecasts help businesses plan for future demand.
- B) Companies should avoid using past sales information.
- C) Forecasts are always completely accurate.
- D) Customers prefer businesses with no inventory.

RC6-011

Question: What information may be used in an inventory forecast?

- A) Employee birthdays
 - B) Past sales and seasonal patterns
 - C) Building inspection dates
 - D) Parking assignments
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RC6-012

Question: What may happen if a company orders too little inventory?

- A) It may run out of popular items.
 - B) It may reduce customer interest.
 - C) It may eliminate the need for storage.
 - D) It may stop using forecasts.
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RC6-013

Question: Why do managers review forecasts regularly?

- A) To avoid making any changes
 - B) To adjust them when new information becomes available
 - C) To replace all customer orders
 - D) To increase storage costs
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RC6-014

Question: Which conclusion is best supported by the passage?

- A) Forecasting can help companies balance cost and customer demand.

- B) Inventory decisions do not affect customers.
 - C) Businesses should always order the largest possible amount.
 - D) Forecasts are useful only after products are sold.
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Passage 4

The development of public water treatment systems greatly improved health and daily life in many communities. Before these systems were common, people often relied on wells, rivers, or other local sources that could become contaminated. Unsafe water could spread disease and make communities more vulnerable to illness.

Water treatment systems use several steps to remove harmful materials and reduce health risks. These steps may include filtering, settling, and disinfecting the water before it reaches homes and businesses.

Today, public water treatment remains an essential service. Engineers and utility workers continue to monitor systems, test water quality, and maintain equipment to keep water supplies reliable.

RC6-015

Question: What is the main idea of the passage?

- A) Public water treatment systems improved community health and reliability.
 - B) Communities no longer need water testing.
 - C) Wells are always safer than treated water.
 - D) Water treatment systems are used only in factories.
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RC6-016

Question: What risk existed before public water treatment systems were common?

- A) Water sources could become contaminated.
- B) Water was always disinfected.
- C) Homes received too much treated water.
- D) Engineers avoided water testing.

RC6-017

Question: Which step may be used in water treatment?

- A) Painting
 - B) Filtering
 - C) Packaging
 - D) Shipping
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RC6-018

Question: How is the passage organized?

- A) Problem, solution, and continuing importance
 - B) Comparison of two unrelated jobs
 - C) Instructions for repairing a water pump
 - D) List of customer complaints
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Passage 5

A company that repairs industrial equipment recently introduced a customer service portal. Before the portal was launched, customers usually called the service desk to request repairs, ask about job status, or submit equipment information. During busy periods, callers sometimes waited longer than expected.

The new portal allows customers to submit service requests online, upload photos of equipment problems, and check the status of existing jobs. Service managers report that the portal has reduced call volume and helped technicians receive clearer information before arriving at a job site.

The company continues to offer phone support for customers who prefer it, but leaders expect online usage to grow as customers become more comfortable with the system.

RC6-019

Question: What is the main idea of the passage?

- A) The company stopped repairing industrial equipment.
 - B) A customer service portal improved repair-request handling.
 - C) Customers are no longer allowed to call the service desk.
 - D) Technicians now complete all repairs remotely.
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RC6-020

Question: What problem sometimes occurred before the portal was launched?

- A) Customers could not describe equipment problems.
 - B) Callers sometimes waited longer than expected.
 - C) Technicians refused job assignments.
 - D) Equipment photos were required for every repair.
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RC6-021

Question: What can customers do through the portal?

- A) Submit service requests and upload photos
 - B) Approve employee schedules
 - C) Purchase replacement vehicles
 - D) Close the service department
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RC6-022

Question: How has the portal helped technicians?

- A) It has eliminated all travel to job sites.
 - B) It has helped them receive clearer information before arriving.
 - C) It has reduced the need for repair tools.
 - D) It has prevented customers from asking questions.
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RC6-023

Question: The word “launched” most nearly means:

- A) Measured
 - B) Introduced
 - C) Delayed
 - D) Removed
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Passage 6

Many workplaces use checklists to support consistent performance. A checklist may list required steps for opening a facility, inspecting equipment, preparing materials, or closing a work area at the end of a shift.

Checklists are useful because they reduce reliance on memory. Even experienced workers can forget a step when they are tired, interrupted, or working under time pressure. A clear checklist helps employees confirm that important tasks have been completed.

However, a checklist is only helpful when it is accurate and actually used. Supervisors may review checklists periodically to make sure they still match current procedures.

RC6-024

Question: What is the main idea of the passage?

- A) Checklists can improve consistency when they are accurate and used properly.
 - B) Experienced workers never need written instructions.
 - C) Workplaces should avoid reviewing procedures.
 - D) Checklists are useful only for new employees.
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RC6-025

Question: Why can checklists be useful?

- A) They reduce reliance on memory.
- B) They eliminate all workplace errors.

- C) They replace supervisors.
 - D) They make procedures unnecessary.
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RC6-026

Question: According to the passage, when might even experienced workers forget a step?

- A) When they are tired or interrupted
 - B) When they receive a promotion
 - C) When procedures are updated yearly
 - D) When they work in a quiet area
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RC6-027

Question: Why may supervisors review checklists periodically?

- A) To make sure they match current procedures
 - B) To remove all required steps
 - C) To reduce employee training
 - D) To replace equipment inspections
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RC6-028

Question: Which conclusion is best supported by the passage?

- A) A checklist is most useful when it reflects real work procedures.
 - B) Checklists should never be changed.
 - C) Memory is always more reliable than written steps.
 - D) Written procedures prevent every workplace problem.
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Passage 7

Many communities use stormwater drainage systems to manage rainwater runoff. When rain falls on roads, parking lots, and rooftops, the water cannot always soak naturally into the ground. Instead, it flows across hard surfaces and must be directed away from streets and buildings.

Drainage systems may include gutters, storm drains, pipes, retention ponds, and channels. These systems help reduce flooding and limit damage during heavy rainfall. They also help prevent water from collecting in areas where it could create safety hazards.

Regular maintenance is important because leaves, trash, and sediment can block drainage pathways. When systems are not maintained, even moderate rain can cause problems.

RC6-029

Question: What is the passage mainly about?

- A) How stormwater drainage systems manage runoff and prevent problems
 - B) Why communities should remove all paved surfaces
 - C) How rainwater is used to generate electricity
 - D) Why rooftops require frequent replacement
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RC6-030

Question: Why does rainwater flow across roads and parking lots?

- A) Hard surfaces prevent it from soaking naturally into the ground.
 - B) Roads absorb water faster than soil.
 - C) Parking lots are designed to collect drinking water.
 - D) Rainwater cannot move through pipes.
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RC6-031

Question: Which item may be part of a drainage system?

- A) Office furniture
- B) Storm drains
- C) Employee lockers

D) Traffic signs

RC6-032

Question: Why is maintenance important for drainage systems?

- A) Leaves, trash, and sediment can block drainage pathways.
 - B) Rainfall stops drainage systems from working.
 - C) Maintenance increases flooding.
 - D) Drainage systems are useful only in dry weather.
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Passage 8

A manufacturing company recently reviewed its employee suggestion program. The program allows workers to submit ideas for improving safety, reducing waste, or making production more efficient.

During the review, managers found that several employee suggestions had led to useful changes. One team proposed reorganizing frequently used tools closer to workstations, which reduced unnecessary walking time. Another employee suggested clearer labels for storage bins, helping workers locate materials more quickly.

After reviewing the results, company leaders decided to continue the program and provide quarterly updates about suggestions that are adopted. They believe this will encourage more employees to participate.

RC6-033

Question: What is the purpose of the employee suggestion program?

- A) To allow workers to submit improvement ideas
 - B) To replace supervisors
 - C) To reduce all employee communication
 - D) To assign overtime schedules
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RC6-034

Question: What change reduced unnecessary walking time?

- A) Installing new parking signs
 - B) Reorganizing frequently used tools closer to workstations
 - C) Removing storage bins
 - D) Reducing the number of workstations
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RC6-035

Question: What did company leaders decide to do?

- A) End the suggestion program immediately
 - B) Continue the program and provide quarterly updates
 - C) Require customers to submit suggestions
 - D) Limit ideas to production managers only
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RC6-036

Question: Which statement is best supported by the passage?

- A) Employee input can lead to practical workplace improvements.
 - B) Suggestion programs never produce useful changes.
 - C) Workers should not participate in process improvements.
 - D) Clear labels make materials harder to locate.
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IBEW Aptitude Test Reading Comprehension

Exam 6

Part B — Answer Key & Explanations

RC6-001 — Correct: B

Explanation: The passage focuses on how the warehouse improved delivery recordkeeping by replacing paper forms with a scanning system that uploads information directly to a database.

RC6-002 — Correct: B

Explanation: The old process sometimes caused delays because paperwork could be incomplete, misplaced, or entered incorrectly.

RC6-003 — Correct: A

Explanation: The passage states that when clerks scan delivery documents, the information is automatically uploaded to the warehouse database.

RC6-004 — Correct: B

Explanation: Managers can use the data to identify suppliers that often deliver late or send incomplete orders.

RC6-005 — Correct: A

Explanation: In context, “recurring” means happening repeatedly. The passage refers to problems that happen more than once and need to be addressed.

RC6-006 — Correct: A

Explanation: The notice announces that employees must complete an updated safety orientation before using the new loading dock equipment.

RC6-007 — Correct: B

Explanation: The notice states that the orientation includes a brief classroom review and a supervised equipment demonstration.

RC6-008 — Correct: A

Explanation: The updated orientation was created because supervisors observed that some employees were unfamiliar with the new controls.

RC6-009 — Correct: C

Explanation: Supervisors will verify completion before assigning employees to loading dock duties.

RC6-010 — Correct: A

Explanation: The passage explains how inventory forecasts help businesses estimate future product demand and make better purchasing and production decisions.

RC6-011 — Correct: B

Explanation: The passage lists past sales, seasonal patterns, customer orders, and current market conditions as possible sources for forecasts.

RC6-012 — Correct: A

Explanation: If a company orders too little inventory, it may run out of popular items and disappoint customers.

RC6-013 — Correct: B

Explanation: Managers review forecasts regularly so they can adjust them when new information becomes available.

RC6-014 — Correct: A

Explanation: The passage shows that forecasting helps companies avoid ordering too much or too little, balancing storage costs with customer demand.

RC6-015 — Correct: A

Explanation: The passage describes how public water treatment systems reduced health risks and continue to help keep water supplies reliable.

RC6-016 — Correct: A

Explanation: Before public treatment systems were common, local water sources such as wells and rivers could become contaminated.

RC6-017 — Correct: B

Explanation: Filtering is specifically listed as one step that may be used in water treatment.

RC6-018 — Correct: A

Explanation: The passage first explains the problem of unsafe water, then describes water treatment as a solution, and finally explains its continuing importance today.

RC6-019 — Correct: B

Explanation: The passage focuses on how the customer service portal improved the way repair requests are submitted, tracked, and handled.

RC6-020 — Correct: B

Explanation: Before the portal, callers sometimes waited longer than expected during busy periods.

RC6-021 — Correct: A

Explanation: Customers can use the portal to submit service requests online and upload photos of equipment problems.

RC6-022 — Correct: B

Explanation: The portal helps technicians receive clearer information before arriving at a job site.

RC6-023 — Correct: B

Explanation: In context, “launched” means introduced or started. The passage says the portal was made available to customers.

RC6-024 — Correct: A

Explanation: The passage explains that checklists support consistent performance, but only if they are accurate and actually used.

RC6-025 — Correct: A

Explanation: Checklists are useful because they reduce reliance on memory, especially when workers are tired, interrupted, or under pressure.

RC6-026 — Correct: A

Explanation: The passage states that even experienced workers can forget a step when they are tired, interrupted, or working under time pressure.

RC6-027 — Correct: A

Explanation: Supervisors may review checklists to make sure they still match current procedures.

RC6-028 — Correct: A

Explanation: The passage supports the idea that a checklist works best when it accurately reflects the procedures employees actually need to follow.

RC6-029 — Correct: A

Explanation: The passage explains what stormwater drainage systems do, why they are needed, and how maintenance helps prevent flooding and safety problems.

RC6-030 — Correct: A

Explanation: The passage states that hard surfaces such as roads, parking lots, and rooftops prevent rainwater from soaking naturally into the ground.

RC6-031 — Correct: B

Explanation: Storm drains are specifically listed as one part of a stormwater drainage system.

RC6-032 — Correct: A

Explanation: Maintenance is important because leaves, trash, and sediment can block drainage pathways and cause problems during rain.

RC6-033 — Correct: A

Explanation: The employee suggestion program allows workers to submit ideas for improving safety, reducing waste, or improving efficiency.

RC6-034 — Correct: B

Explanation: One team suggested reorganizing frequently used tools closer to workstations, which reduced unnecessary walking time.

RC6-035 — Correct: B

Explanation: Company leaders decided to continue the program and provide quarterly updates about adopted suggestions.

RC6-036 — Correct: A

Explanation: The passage gives examples of employee ideas that led to useful changes, showing that employee input can improve workplace processes.

Answer Summary

Question Answer

RC6-001 B
RC6-002 B
RC6-003 A
RC6-004 B
RC6-005 A
RC6-006 A
RC6-007 B
RC6-008 A
RC6-009 C
RC6-010 A
RC6-011 B
RC6-012 A
RC6-013 B
RC6-014 A
RC6-015 A
RC6-016 A
RC6-017 B
RC6-018 A
RC6-019 B
RC6-020 B
RC6-021 A
RC6-022 B
RC6-023 B
RC6-024 A
RC6-025 A
RC6-026 A
RC6-027 A
RC6-028 A
RC6-029 A
RC6-030 A
RC6-031 B
RC6-032 A
RC6-033 A
RC6-034 B
RC6-035 B
RC6-036 A